

Asking for a Raise

If you already have a job but feel underpaid, you may be thinking about asking your boss for a raise. If this is the case, you need to be prepared to convince the powers that be that you not only deserve one, but that you're worth it. Don't make the common mistake of basing your request on your need for more money or your inability to meet your financial obligations. Businesses do not base salary increases on employees' personal needs; they base increases on employees' worth to the company, the quality of their work, company pay scales, and budgetary concerns.



What's the number one rule for requesting a raise?

Don't give ultimatums. They'll put your boss on the defensive, and may force you to quit your job or eat crow. Your goal is to convince your boss that you're worth more money because you do an exceptional job or you've accepted additional responsibility that warrants an increase or promotion.

Evaluate Yourself

First, perform an evaluation of your skills, productivity, job tasks, and contribution to the company. Look at your job duties and performance from the company's perspective and base your approach on the company's needs. If you have a written job description, dig it out, along with copies of your last two or three written performance reviews. Jot down the major tasks you perform that may not be part of your formal job description. The goal is to show or remind your boss of your tangible contributions to the company, so make a list of your accomplishments, and if possible, the dollar value of